

The `fbf` package—a Bembo-like font

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I The Package

The `fbf` package offers a family of Bembo-like fonts derived from Cardo in the usual four styles. Text figures may be selected from four types:

- Proportional lining (LF), selected by options `lining`, `proportional` [or `p`]; [lining is the default figure style;]
- Tabular lining (TLF), selected by options `lining`, `tabular`; [tabular is the default figure alignment;]
- Proportional oldstyle (OsF), selected by option `oldstyle`, `proportional` [or `p`];
- Tabular oldstyle (TOsF), selected by options `oldstyle`, `tabular`.

The package also defines six macros that allow you use alternate figure styles locally:

```
\textlf{97} % print 97 in proportional lining figures
\texttlf{97} % print 97 in tabular lining figures
\textosf{97} % print 97 in proportional oldstyle figures
\texttosf{97} % print 97 in tabular oldstyle figures
\textsu{97} % print 97 in superior figures
\textin{97} % print 97 in inferior figures
\textde{97} % print 97 in denominator figures (same as inferior, but raised to baseline.)
```

As of version 1.15 (mid-2020), there is a new macro `\textfrac` that may be used to construct simple fractions. For example, `\textfrac[2]{7}{8}` renders as 2 $\frac{7}{8}$. (If the optional argument is not specified, you get just the fraction.) There are two options to `fbf.sty` that may be used to modify the space before and after the solidus: `foresolidus` and `aftsolidus`, which should be specified in em units. Their default values are `.04em` and `0em` respectively.

New in version 1.16: A swash version of Q has been added to all faces. You may enable it globally using option `swashQ` to `ETbb`, or specify it locally with the macro `\Qswash`, which renders as Q̣. If you had enabled it globally, you have access to the ordinary Q with the macro `\Qnoswash`.

Option `altP` changes the form of the letter capital P from its default closed shape, as used in almost all modern digital renderings of Bembo, to the more historically accurate open shape, P̣. See, for example, the reproduction of Pietro Bembo's *De Aetna* at <https://ia601405.us.archive.org/34/items/ita-bnc-ald-00000673-001/ita-bnc-ald-00000673-001.pdf>. (A higher resolution rendering of a two-page sample is available from https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/8/89/De_Aetna_1495.jpg.) Unicode T_EX users may load `fbf` with the equivalent to `altP` by the code block

```
\usepackage{fontspec}
\setmainfont{fbf}[%
UprightFeatures = {StylisticSet=01},
BoldFeatures = {StylisticSet=01}
]
```

(Capital P in italic and bold italic is already open—those faces have no `ss01` feature.)